

A PRACTICAL FIELD GUIDE

The AI Builder's Playbook

Turn any idea into a real, live website using free AI tools — without writing a single line of code yourself.

01

DEFINE

Validate the idea

02

DESIGN

Plan & prototype

03

DEVELOP

Build with AI

04

DEPLOY

Go live online

Everything here is built for complete beginners. No coding background needed. You will direct the AI — it does the technical work. By the end, you will know exactly which tool to open, what to type, and what to do when something breaks.

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FIND MY WORK

rahulbonala.me

6+ live projects, zero manual code

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START HERE

What this guide is, and how to use it

You have an idea. Maybe it is a small business website, a tool you wish existed, or an app for your college project. This guide takes you from that idea all the way to a working website with a real link you can share — using AI tools that are free to start.

The one belief this guide is built on

You do not need to learn to code. You need to learn to **direct**. Modern AI tools can write code, design screens, and deploy websites. Your job is to tell them clearly what you want, and to know what to do when something does not work. That is a skill anyone can learn in an afternoon — and this guide is the map.

Who this is for

College students, early-career techies, and curious beginners who want to build real things with AI but do not know which tool to use, when to use it, or how the pieces fit together. If you have ever opened ten browser tabs and felt lost, this guide is for you.

What you will have by the end

After following this guide you will own:

- ✓ A validated idea with a clear name and one-line description
- ✓ A complete product plan (a PRD) that any AI can build from
- ✓ A working website built entirely by AI, saved safely online
- ✓ A live link, hosted for free, that you can share with anyone
- ✓ The confidence to fix problems yourself using AI — never stuck

How to read this

Work through it in order the first time. The four phases — Define, Design, Develop, Deploy — build on each other, and skipping ahead is the most common way beginners get stuck. Every prompt in this guide is written for you to copy directly; the text inside **[square brackets]** is the only part you change. A single worked example — a pet-care booking website — runs through the whole guide so you can see one real idea travel from start to finish.

FOUNDATIONS

The mindset & your setup

Two things make the difference between people who finish and people who give up: the right mental model, and having your accounts ready before you begin. Five minutes here saves an hour later.

Three ideas to hold in your head

- 1 You are the director, not the typist**
The AI writes the code. You decide what gets built and judge whether it is right. Think of yourself as the person giving instructions to a very fast, very literal team.
- 2 Specific instructions get good results**
Vague requests produce vague output. “Build me an app” gives you junk. “Build a booking page with these colours and these four sections” gives you something usable. Detail is your superpower.
- 3 Breaking things is normal — and fixable**
Code will break. That is not failure, it is the process. The AI that built it can also fix it. You will learn the exact words to say. You are never truly stuck.

Set up these five free accounts first

Create all of these now, before you start Phase 1. Each takes about two minutes. All are free to begin with — you only pay later if you choose to.

TOOL	WHERE	WHAT YOU USE IT FOR
Claude	claude.ai	Validating ideas and fixing errors in plain English
Gemini	gemini.google.com	Researching your idea and writing your product plan
Google Stitch	stitch.withgoogle.com	Turning your plan into visual screens
Antigravity	antigravity.google	The AI tool that actually builds your website
GitHub	github.com	Safely saving every version of your code
Vercel	vercel.com	Publishing your website live, for free

TIP

Antigravity is a desktop application (it works like a code editor you download for Windows, Mac, or Linux), not a website. The other tools all run in your browser. Download Antigravity from antigravity.google when you reach Phase 3.

THE BIG PICTURE

The four phases, at a glance

Every project in this guide follows the same four steps. Read this page once to see the whole journey before you dive into the detail. Each phase has a clear job, a main tool, and a finish line.

01**DEFINE***Validate & sharpen your idea***~10 min**

Use AI to check whether your idea already exists, make it sharper, and decide what to build first. You end with a clear, named idea and a one-line pitch.

02**DESIGN***Plan it & see it***~15-20 min**

Write a PRD — a simple plan describing your product — then turn it into visual screens with AI. You end with a blueprint and a prototype of every page.

03**DEVELOP***Build it with AI***~20-40 min**

Hand your plan to Antigravity and it writes the actual website code. You guide and correct it, and save your work safely. You end with a working website on your computer.

04**DEPLOY***Put it online***~5 min**

Publish your website to the internet with Vercel, for free. You end with a real link, live and ready to share with the world.

TIP

The phases are deliberately in this order. The most common beginner mistake is jumping straight to “build” without defining or designing first — which is exactly why the AI then produces something random. Trust the sequence.

THE CORE SKILL

How to write a prompt that works

Everything in this guide depends on one skill: asking AI clearly. Master this single page and every prompt that follows will make sense. A strong prompt has up to six parts — you will not always need all six, but knowing them means you are never guessing.

ROLE	Tell the AI who to be. This sets the quality and expertise of the answer. Act as a product designer with 10 years of experience.
TASK	Say exactly what you want done. Be direct and specific. Analyse this customer feedback and identify the top 3 pain points.
CONTEXT	Give the background the AI needs to be relevant. The feedback is for a new AI-powered scheduling app.
FORMAT	Describe how the answer should be structured. Give the output as a bulleted list with a short note on each point.
CONSTRAINT	Set the boundaries — what to include, avoid, or limit. Do not include general praise — only genuine complaints.
INPUT	Provide the actual material the AI should work on. Feedback: "" [paste the feedback here] ""

All six parts in one real prompt**A COMPLETE, WELL-STRUCTURED PROMPT**

Notice how each part narrows the result until the output is exactly what you need.

Role: Act as a data analyst.

Task: Analyse the following customer feedback and identify the top 3 pain points.

Context: The feedback is for a new AI-powered scheduling app.

Format: Provide the output as a bulleted list.

Constraint: Do not include general praise, only complaints.

Feedback: "" [paste your feedback text here] ""

TIP

Every prompt in this guide already follows this structure for you. Once you understand the six parts, you can write your own prompts for anything — not just the ones printed here.

01

PHASE 01 · ~10 minutes

Define

Validate and sharpen your idea before you build anything.

The goal of this phase is to make sure your idea is worth building, and to get crystal clear on what “version one” actually is. Ten minutes of thinking here will save you days of building the wrong thing. You will use AI as a thinking partner — to pressure-test your idea and sharpen it.

TOOLS FOR THIS PHASE

Claude

claude.ai

Best for honest, thoughtful analysis of your idea

Gemini

gemini.google.com

Strong at research and finding similar products

Step 1 — Validate your idea

Open Claude or Gemini and paste the prompt below. Replace the bracketed text with your own idea. The AI will tell you honestly whether it already exists, how yours is different, and what to build first.

PROMPT 1 · IDEA VALIDATION*Replace [the bracketed text] with your idea, then paste into Claude or Gemini.*

I have an idea: [describe your idea in 2–3 clear sentences].

Please answer these five questions honestly:

1. Does something like this already exist? List 3 similar products.
2. What makes my idea different from those?
3. Who is the ideal user? Describe them in detail.
4. What are the 3 most important features to build first?
5. What is the biggest risk or challenge with this idea?

Keep it short, clear, and honest. No fluff.

WORKED EXAMPLE · How the pet-care idea looks once the brackets are filled in

I have an idea: A mobile-friendly website where pet owners in Bengaluru can book a trusted dog walker for a chosen time slot and pay online.

Please answer these five questions honestly:

1. Does something like this already exist? ...

Step 2 — Improve and name your idea

Stay in the same chat so the AI remembers the context. This prompt turns a rough idea into something with a real name, a clear pitch, and a sharp problem statement — the raw material for your plan in Phase 2.

PROMPT 2 · IMPROVE & NAME

Run this in the SAME chat as Prompt 1.

Based on our discussion, help me improve this idea. Give me:

- 3 catchy, easy-to-remember product name options
- A one-line description anyone understands in 10 seconds
- A problem statement in this exact format:
"People who [situation] struggle with [problem]
because [reason]. My product solves this by [solution]."
- A suggested homepage headline
- The text for the main call-to-action button

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

If the AI's answer feels generic, your idea description was too vague. Add detail about exactly who your user is and why they would care — then run Prompt 1 again. Better input always means better output.

You have finished Phase 1 when you have:

- ✓ Confirmation your idea is worth building (and how it is different)
- ✓ One product name, chosen from the three suggested
- ✓ A one-line description you could say out loud to anyone
- ✓ A clear problem statement in the given format

02

PHASE 02 · ~15-20 minutes

Design

Write the plan, then turn it into screens you can see.

This phase produces two things: a **PRD** (a Product Requirement Document — simply a plan describing your product) and a **prototype** (a visual mock-up of every screen). The PRD is the single most important document you will create. It is the blueprint the AI builds from in Phase 3. Skip it, and the AI guesses — and guessing produces mess.

TOOLS FOR THIS PHASE

Gemini

gemini.google.com

Writes your full PRD from a single prompt

Google Stitch

stitch.withgoogle.com

Turns your PRD into up to 5 screens, free

Figma

figma.com

Optional — for polishing the design further

Step 1 — Write your PRD

Open Gemini in a fresh chat and paste the prompt below, dropping in your idea details from Phase 1. Gemini will produce a complete, structured plan. Save the result — you will reuse it twice more.

PROMPT 3 · CREATE YOUR PRD

Paste into Gemini. Replace [the bracket] with your name and one-liner from Phase 1.

Create a detailed PRD (Product Requirement Document) for:
[paste your product name and one-line description]

Include each of these sections, with clear headings:

- Product name and one-line description
- Problem statement (who, what, why it matters)
- Target users (describe 2 types of user)
- Core features (exactly 5, each with a short description)
- User flow (step by step, from landing to finishing the goal)
- Pages needed (list each page and what goes on it)
- Colour palette (3 colours with hex codes that fit the product)
- Fonts (one for headings, one for body text)
- What NOT to build in version 1 (keep the scope small)

Use headings and bullet points. Be specific, not vague.

Step 2 — Turn your PRD into screens

Google Stitch reads your plan and generates the actual screens — up to five at once. Go to stitch.withgoogle.com, start a new project, and paste the prompt below with your full PRD. In about ninety seconds you will see your product take visual shape.

PROMPT 4 · GENERATE THE PROTOTYPE

Paste into Google Stitch, with your full PRD included where shown.

Here is my product PRD:

[paste your full PRD from Gemini]

Create a visual prototype based on this PRD with:

- Every page from the PRD, with realistic content
- The exact colours specified: [paste your hex codes]
- The fonts specified: [paste your font names]
- Clear placement of buttons, images, text and navigation
- A mobile-friendly layout that also works on desktop
- A clean, modern look with no clutter

TIP

If the prototype looks off, the fix is almost always in the PRD, not in Stitch. Go back to Gemini, add more detail to the layout and pages section, regenerate the PRD, then run Stitch again. Stitch also lets you export your screens to Figma or as code if you want to refine them.

You have finished Phase 2 when you have:

- ✓ A complete PRD document, saved somewhere you can find it
- ✓ A visual prototype showing every page of your product
- ✓ Your three colour hex codes written down
- ✓ Your heading and body font names written down

03 PHASE 03 · ~20-40 minutes

Develop

Hand your plan to AI and watch it build the real thing.

Now the website gets built — and you still will not write code. You will use **Antigravity**, Google's AI development tool: a desktop app where AI agents plan, write, test, and fix code for you, even opening a browser to check their own work. You give it your PRD; it produces a working website. Two words to know first: **GitHub** is like Google Drive for your code, and a **commit** is simply pressing "save".

TOOLS FOR THIS PHASE

Antigravity

antigravity.google

Download it (desktop app) — the AI builds here

GitHub

github.com

Saves every version of your code, safely

Claude

claude.ai

Explains and fixes any error in plain English

Step 1 — Build your website

Download and open Antigravity, start a new project, and paste the prompt below. Take your time filling in the brackets — the care you put into this prompt is exactly what you get back in quality.

PROMPT 5 · THE MAIN BUILD (the most important prompt)

Paste into Antigravity. Fill every bracket carefully using your PRD.

Build a [landing page / web app / booking site]
called "[your product name]".

Here is the full PRD:

[paste your entire PRD from Gemini]

Requirements:

- Build every page in the PRD — skip none
- Use these exact colours: [paste your hex codes]
- Use these exact fonts: [paste your font names]
- Fully responsive: perfect on both mobile and desktop
- Realistic placeholder content — no "Lorem ipsum"
- Build the homepage first, then the other pages
- Smooth hover effects on buttons and links
- Clean, modern code that is easy to change later

Step 2 — Fix anything that breaks

This is the single most valuable skill in the whole guide. When you see an error — and you will — do not panic and do not try to fix the code by hand. Copy the error exactly, and paste it into this prompt. The AI understands its own mistakes better than anyone.

PROMPT 6 · FIX ANY ERROR (use this every single time)

Paste into Claude or Antigravity. Copy the error word-for-word.

I got this error in my project:

[paste the exact error message – word for word]

Please do four things:

1. Explain what this error means, in plain language
2. Tell me the exact line to change and what to change it to
3. Tell me if this fix could cause any other problem
4. Confirm the code will work after the fix

Step 3 — Save your work to GitHub

- 1 Go to github.com, create a free account, click “New Repository”, give it your project’s name, and click “Create”.
- 2 In Antigravity, find “Connect to GitHub” and select the repository you just made.
- 3 Click “Commit Changes” and write a short note such as “first version of homepage”.
- 4 Your code is now saved. If anything breaks later, you can always restore this working version.

WHEN IT GOES WRONG

If the design does not match what you pictured, be specific: “The header section does not look right. It should have the logo on the left and the menu on the right. Please update it.” The AI cannot read your mind, but it responds extremely well to clear, specific corrections.

You have finished Phase 3 when you have:

- ✓ A working website with every page from your PRD
- ✓ Your code saved in a GitHub repository
- ✓ Checked that it looks right on both mobile and desktop
- ✓ Fixed any remaining errors using Prompt 6

04

PHASE 04 · ~5 minutes

Deploy

Put your website online with a real, shareable link.

This is the moment your project becomes real. Deploying means publishing your website to the internet so anyone, anywhere, can open it. With Vercel it is genuinely free and takes about five minutes — no servers, no settings. You connect GitHub, click deploy, and you get a live link.

TOOLS FOR THIS PHASE

Vercelvercel.com

Publishes your site live, free, in minutes

GoDaddygodaddy.com

Optional — buy a custom domain name later

Search Consolesearch.google.com

Optional — helps Google find your site

Deploy on Vercel, step by step

- 1 Go to vercel.com, click “Sign Up”, and choose “Continue with GitHub” (use the same email as your GitHub).
- 2 Click “Add New Project”, then “Import Git Repository”.
- 3 Find your project in the list and click “Import”.
- 4 Vercel detects everything automatically — just click “Deploy”. No settings to change.
- 5 Wait one to three minutes. You receive a free live link such as `yourproject.vercel.app` — share it!

If the deployment shows an error

PROMPT 7 · FIX A DEPLOYMENT ERROR*Copy the error from the Vercel log and paste it into Claude or Antigravity.*

My Vercel deployment failed with this error:

[paste the exact error from the Vercel deploy log]

Please tell me: which file to open, what text to find, and what to replace it with. After I fix it and commit to GitHub, Vercel will automatically deploy again.

You have finished Phase 4 — and the whole build — when you have:

- ✓ A live website link ending in `.vercel.app` (or your own domain)
- ✓ Opened the link on your phone and on a computer — both work
- ✓ Shared it with at least one person to confirm it loads for them

GOING FURTHER

After you launch

Your site is live — congratulations. These are the optional next steps once you are ready to grow it, plus the hard-won principles that keep every build on track.

Optional next steps

Custom domain	Buy a name at GoDaddy or Namecheap, then add it in Vercel under Settings → Domains.	₹500-₹1,000 / year
Get on Google	Add your site to Google Search Console and submit your sitemap. Google indexes it within 2-48 hours.	Free
Make it an app	Turning your site into an Android or iOS app is a separate process — ask in the community when you are ready.	Separate guide

Five golden rules

- 1 Be specific in every prompt. Vague questions get vague answers.
- 2 When something breaks, do not panic — paste the error into AI.
- 3 Build the simple version first, then add features one at a time.
- 4 Commit to GitHub after every meaningful change. It takes seconds.
- 5 You are the director. The AI is your team. Lead it clearly.

AVOID THESE

Common mistakes & a plain-English glossary

Most beginners trip on the same handful of things. Here is what to avoid — and a quick dictionary of every technical word used in this guide, explained simply.

The five most common mistakes

THE MISTAKE	WHY IT HURTS	DO THIS INSTEAD
Describing the idea too vaguely	The AI has nothing to work with, so the output is generic.	Say who uses it, what it does, and why they need it.
Skipping the PRD	The AI guesses, and the build comes out random and messy.	Always write the PRD first. It is your blueprint.
Fixing code by hand	You break more than you fix and lose hours.	Paste the error into AI — it fixes its own code best.
Building everything at once	It gets complex, breaks often, and never ships.	Build three core features, ship, then add more.
Forgetting to commit	One bad change and your work is gone.	Commit to GitHub after every meaningful step.

Plain-English glossary

PRD	Product Requirement Document — a simple written plan describing what your product is and does.
Prototype	A visual mock-up of your screens, before any real code exists.
Repository (repo)	A project folder stored on GitHub that holds all your code.
Commit	Saving a snapshot of your code to GitHub that you can return to.
Deploy	Publishing your website to the internet so others can visit it.
Responsive	A site that looks good on any screen size — phone, tablet, or desktop.
Hex code	A six-character code like #C2410C that represents an exact colour.
Domain	Your website's custom address, such as yourname.com.
Agent	An AI that can act on its own — planning, writing, and testing, not just chatting.

KEEP THIS HANDY

Every tool, and where to find it

The full toolkit in one place. Bookmark each link. Everything here is free to start — you only ever pay if you choose to add a custom domain.

01 · DEFINE

Claude	claude.ai	Free
Gemini	gemini.google.com	Free

02 · DESIGN

Gemini (PRD)	gemini.google.com	Free
Google Stitch	stitch.withgoogle.com	Free
Figma	figma.com	Free tier

03 · DEVELOP

Antigravity	antigravity.google	Free tier
GitHub	github.com	Free
Claude	claude.ai	Free

04 · DEPLOY

Vercel	vercel.com	Free tier
GoDaddy	godaddy.com	₹500+/yr
Search Console	search.google.com	Free

REMEMBER THIS ABOVE EVERYTHING

If something breaks, you are never stuck.

Open Claude, paste the error, and say: “Fix this and explain what went wrong in simple words.” The AI built it — the AI can fix it. You only have to ask.

SEE IT IN ACTION

rahulbonala.me

6+ real projects built with this exact pipeline — a ride-hailing app, a pet-care marketplace, a voice-to-checklist tool, and more. All built with zero manual code. All live.

WORK WITH ME

AI Builders by Rahul

Join the community for help, updates, and new AI tools. Book a 1-on-1 “Zero to Live” session and build your first project with me beside you.